



Consent for Research Participation

Study title: Performance and Moral Trust as Distinct Dimensions of Human-Robot Trust

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We're inviting you to participate in a research study. Participation is completely voluntary. If you agree to participate, you can always change your mind and withdraw. There are no negative consequences, whatever you decide.

What is the purpose of this study?

The purpose of this study is to better understand how people develop trust in robotic teammates. Specifically, we are interested in whether trust based on a robot's performance is different from trust based on a robot's intentions and cooperative behavior. The results may help researchers design more trustworthy and effective robotic systems.

What will I do and how long will it take?

If you agree to participate, you will complete a brief demographic questionnaire and several trust-related surveys. You will then play a seven-round online search-and-rescue game with a simulated robot teammate. During the game, both you and the robot will collect targets and decide whether to contribute points to a team score or keep them individually. After the game, you will complete additional questionnaires about your perceptions of the robot, including questions about trust, reliability, transparency, and cooperation. Participation is expected to take approximately 20–30 minutes.

The full purpose of this research cannot be disclosed before you participate, but will be told to you at the end.

Could being in this research hurt me?

- There is a chance your data could be seen by someone who shouldn't have access to it. We're minimizing this risk in the following ways:
 - Data collected will be de-identified.
 - We'll store all electronic data on the UML server or UML OneDrive
- There is a risk that your online data could be intercepted: This is a risk you experience any time you provide information online. We're using a secure system to collect this data, but we can't completely eliminate this risk.



Consent for Research Participation

What happens if I am injured because I took part in this research?

Your welfare is a concern of every member of the research team. If you have a problem as a direct result of being in this study, you should immediately contact one of the people listed at the beginning of this consent form. The University of Massachusetts Lowell does not provide funds for the treatment of research-related injury. If you are injured as a result of your participation in this study, you or your insurance carrier will be expected to pay the costs of this treatment. No additional financial compensation for injury or lost wages is available. You do not give up any of your legal rights by signing this form.

What other choices do I have besides taking part in this research?

Your alternative is to not take part in the research.

Will being in this research help me in any way? You are not expected to receive any direct benefit from participating. However, your participation may help researchers better understand trust in human-robot interaction and improve the design of future robotic systems.

Will it cost me any money to take part in this research?

No

Will I receive an incentive for participating in this study? You will receive a guaranteed payment of \$13 through the Prolific platform. You may also receive a performance-based bonus of either \$2 or \$7 based on outcomes achieved during the game. Total compensation will range from \$15 to \$20.

Can I be removed from the research without my approval?

You may be removed from the study if you fail attention-check questions designed to verify that participants are reading instructions and responding carefully. Data from incomplete submissions may also be excluded from analysis.

How will my information be stored and when will it be destroyed?

We will collect your responses using a secure online system. Your Prolific ID will be stored separately from research data. Electronic data will be stored on UML OneDrive.

It is possible that we might use the research data in other future research. We may also share data with researchers and companies that are not part of UML. In these cases, we will not share your Prolific ID and we will not come back to you to ask you for your consent.



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Who can see my data?

- We (the researchers) will have access to all data. This is so we can analyze the data and conduct the study.
- The Institutional Review Board (IRB) at UML and NSF may review all the study data. This is to ensure we're following laws and ethical guidelines.
- We may share our findings in publications or presentations. If we do, the results will be de-identified (noProlific IDs)

Contact information:

For questions about the research, complaints, or problems: For questions about the research, contact: Paul Robinette, Ph.D. – 978-934-3347 – paul_robinette@uml.edu

For questions about your rights as a research participant, complaints, or problems: Contact the UMass Lowell IRB (Institutional Review Board) at 978-934-4134 or at IRB@uml.edu

Please select your choice below. You may print a copy of this consent form for your records. Clicking on the "Agree" button indicates that

- You have read and understand the above information
- You voluntarily agree to participate in the research
- You are 18 years of age or older

☐ Agree

☐ Disagree